Sebastian Ritter Gutierrez

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Research Interests

Regional and spatial economics; migration and mobility; green and twin transitions; territorial conflict; regional inequality; causal inference; geospatial and satellite data.

Summary

PhD Candidate in Economics and researcher in the Regional Quantitative Analysis Group (AQR) at the University of Barcelona. My research studies how spatial frictions – language policy, green and twin transitions, and territorial conflict – shape mobility, local economic activity and regional development. I combine administrative, survey, geospatial and satellite data with causal-inference methods.

Education

2023–present PhD in Economics at **University of Barcelona**
Supervisor: Vicente Royuela `vroyuela@ub.edu`
Thesis: *Essays on Spatial Frictions, Mobility, and Regional Development*

2020–2022 MSc in Economics at **University of Barcelona**
Supervisor: Jordi Jofre-Monseny `jordi.jofre@ub.edu`
Thesis: *The Economic Effect of Splitting a Region: A Case from Chile*

2013–2019 Commercial Engineering degree at **Austral University of Chile**
Supervisor: Susana Coper `susana.coper@gmail.com`
Thesis: *Dynamics of Regional and Communal Employment in the Los Ríos Region through the Classic and Modified Shift-Share Analysis, 2002–2017*

Publications

- Ritter, S., Royuela, V. and Marx, Y. (2026). "Will the Green Transition Deepen Regional Divides? Evidence from Mobility Intentions across European Regions." *The Annals of Regional Science*, 75, article 146. DOI: 10.1007/s00168-026-01583-7.
- Ritter, S. and Royuela, V. (2026). "The Geography of the Green Transition: Performance, Vulnerabilities and Opportunities." *Papers in Regional Science*, article 100150. DOI: 10.1016/j.pirs.2026.100150.
- Ritter, S. (2025). "The Economic Effect of Splitting a Region in a Centralized Country: A Case from Chile." *Global Challenges & Regional Science*, 2, 100011. DOI: 10.1016/j.gcrs.2025.100011.

Working Papers and Work in Progress

- Ritter, S. "Too Far to Matter? The Urban Reach of Rural Territorial Conflict." Job market paper.
- Ritter, S., Di Paolo, A., Ramos, R. and Royuela, V. "Do Language Policies Affect Internal Migration in a Multilingual Country?" In progress.

Grants and Awards

- **AGAUR-FI Joan Oró Predoctoral Fellowship**
  Scholarship awarded by the Government of Catalonia for doctoral studies, 2024–2027.
- **Best Paper Presentation Award, Journal of Regional Research**
  XLVIII International Conference on Regional Science, Cuenca, Spain, October 16–18, 2024.

Selected Conference and Seminar Presentations

- **"Measuring the Green Transition in Europe: A Multidimensional Index for European NUTS2 Regions."** Presented at XLIX International Conference on Regional Science, Pamplona, Spain, October 16–18, 2025; *A Joint Call for Action to Leave No One Behind*, Sarajevo, Bosnia and Herzegovina, November 3–4, 2025.
- **"Do Language Policies Affect Internal Migration in a Multilingual Country?"** Presented at:
  - 50th Symposium of the Spanish Economic Association, Barcelona, Spain, December 17–19, 2025.
  - 8th CEnSE Workshop, Jönköping, Sweden, December 12–13, 2024.
  - XLVIII International Conference on Regional Science, Cuenca, Spain, October 16–18, 2024.
  - 63rd ERSA Congress, Azores, Portugal, August 26–30, 2024.
  - XVI Labour Economics Meeting, Barcelona, Spain, July 11, 2024.
  - RSA Annual Conference, Florence, Italy, June 11–14, 2024.
  - Barcelona School of Economics Labor Economics Summer School, Barcelona, Spain, July 4, 2024.
- **"Twin Transition Effects on Human (Im)mobility: A Multilevel Model Analysis."** XLVIII International Conference on Regional Science, Cuenca, Spain, October 16–18, 2024.
- **"The Economic Effect of Splitting a Region: A Case from Chile."** VI Seminar for New Academic Researchers, Barcelona, Spain, September 14–15, 2023.

Teaching Experience

Substitute Lecturer **Apr 2024–Jun 2024**

Econometrics I, Study Abroad RUIYA Program

Autonomous University of Barcelona, Barcelona, Spain

Responsible for delivering lectures, preparing course materials and assessing student performance. Developed original teaching materials with applied examples from business and economics.

Teaching Assistant **Mar 2017–Jun 2018**

Microeconomics II and Economics II

Austral University of Chile, Valdivia, Chile

Assisted in Microeconomics II for the Commercial Engineering program and in Economics II for the Auditing program. Responsibilities included additional classes focused on solving practical exercises.

Skills

Software	Stata (advanced); Excel (advanced); R, Python and QGIS (intermediate); LaTeX and Git/GitHub (working knowledge); Power BI, SQL and MATLAB (basic).
Languages	Spanish (native); English (advanced); Catalan (basic).

References

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